

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | CrowdStrike Falcon EDR | SIEM/SOAR | Endpoint and Identity Security

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience delivering hands-on security engineering across endpoint protection, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR), identity security, and vulnerability management. I specialise in CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR), Microsoft Sentinel with Kusto Query Language (KQL) detection engineering, and Mimecast email security gateway administration. My background spans managing security tools across large, complex environments including an eight-thousand-user Microsoft Defender deployment, along with strong experience in firewalls, Privileged Access Management (PAM), Mobile Device Management (MDM), Mobile Application Management (MAM), and Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA). I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring a structured, risk-based approach to security operations informed by the NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, MITRE ATT&CK, and ISO 27001. I am confident working as part of a small, focused security team where hands-on technical ownership and accountability matter.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE)
- **SIEM / SOAR:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL detection engineering, playbook automation), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, SOAR workflow development and alert triage
- **Email and Web Security:** Mimecast email security gateway, web application firewall (WAF) policy management, Distributed Denial of Service (DDoS) protection controls
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Microsoft Entra ID (formerly Azure Active Directory), Conditional Access policies, MFA, Single Sign-On (SSO), Group Policy
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, privileged account governance and session monitoring
- **MDM / MAM:** Microsoft Intune, device compliance policies, application protection policies
- **Firewall and Network Security:** Check Point Harmony, firewall rule management, Intrusion Detection System (IDS) and Intrusion Prevention System (IPS) oversight
- **Vulnerability Management:** Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), AppCheck, Nessus; penetration test findings remediation
- **Identity and Cloud Security:** Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Microsoft 365 (M365), Azure security controls
- **Incident Response:** NIST SP 800-61, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, forensic triage, end-to-end incident management
- **Security Awareness:** Delivering organisation-wide security training campaigns and phishing simulation programmes
- **Frameworks:** NIST CSF, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+), MITRE ATT&CK
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting, SOAR playbook automation
- **Certifications:** CISSP, CompTIA Security+, Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA), CompTIA A+, Google IT Support Professional Certificate

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer
University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2025 - Present

- Lead the day-to-day engineering and operations of CrowdStrike Falcon across the endpoint estate, managing EDR policy configuration, prevention policies, threat intelligence feeds and detection tuning to reduce false positives and improve alert fidelity.
- Administer and develop detections within Microsoft Sentinel, authoring KQL queries and analytics rules to identify threats across cloud, endpoint, identity and email telemetry; maintain SOAR playbooks to automate alert triage and incident escalation workflows.
- Manage the Mimecast email security gateway, including inbound and outbound policy configuration, impersonation protection, URL and attachment scanning, and incident investigation for email-borne threats.
- Govern identity security through Microsoft Entra ID, administering Conditional Access policies, MFA controls, SSO integrations and Group Policy to enforce least-privilege access across the organisation.
- Operate the BeyondTrust PAM platform to secure privileged accounts, including session monitoring, credential vaulting and access request workflows.
- Manage Microsoft Intune MDM and MAM policies across all corporate devices, enforcing compliance baselines, encryption, application control and remote wipe capabilities.
- Lead the vulnerability management programme, conducting regular scans using Tenable.io and Pentera BAS to identify, prioritise and track remediation of vulnerabilities; track and validate penetration test findings through to closure.
- Deliver security awareness training campaigns and phishing simulation exercises, reporting engagement metrics to senior stakeholders.
- Manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity and Microsoft 365 Defender, responding to alerts, tuning detection rules and hunting for advanced threats across the Microsoft security ecosystem.
- Monitor and manage firewall rules on Check Point Harmony, reviewing security certificates, maintaining WAF and DDoS protection configurations, and conducting IDS/IPS monitoring.
- Respond to and lead security incidents end-to-end following the NIST SP 800-61 framework, conducting forensic analysis, containing threats and producing post-incident reports.
- Contribute to cyber security risk assessments and provide technical input to governance, risk and compliance activities aligned with ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+).

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

March 2022 - March 2025

University of the Arts, London (UAL)

- Delivered SIEM operations across Microsoft Sentinel, triaging and investigating security alerts, escalating confirmed incidents and developing detection content to improve coverage.
- Supported the deployment and configuration of CrowdStrike Falcon across the endpoint estate, establishing prevention and detection policies and integrating with the SIEM for centralised visibility.
- Managed Mimecast security policies and investigated email security incidents including phishing, business email compromise and malware delivery attempts.
- Administered Entra ID (formerly Azure AD) including user provisioning, access reviews, Conditional Access policy tuning and MFA rollout across the eight-thousand-user estate.
- Supported the vulnerability management programme using Tenable.io and AppCheck, running scans, producing prioritised remediation reports and tracking remediation progress with technical teams.
- Conducted threat hunting across endpoint and identity telemetry using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight and Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries, identifying indicators of compromise and lateral movement.
- Managed Microsoft Intune device compliance policies, ensuring MDM and MAM controls were enforced consistently across Windows, iOS and Android platforms.
- Supported incident response operations, performing initial triage and forensic analysis, and contributing to post-incident reviews.
- Assisted with security awareness training delivery and the configuration of phishing simulation campaigns.
- Maintained Microsoft Defender for Endpoint policies, managing exclusions, alert suppression and automated investigation and response (AIR) capabilities.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

February 2021 - March 2022

HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

- Managed endpoint security and identity tooling across a SaaS and FinTech environment, ensuring compliance with security baselines and policy frameworks.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments and supported remediation activities, producing risk-rated reports for technical and management stakeholders.
- Administered firewall rules, network access controls and intrusion detection configurations to protect infrastructure and data.
- Supported the implementation and maintenance of MDM policies across corporate and bring-your-own-device endpoints.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials compliance activities, assisting with risk registers, evidence collection and control gap analysis.
- Delivered IT infrastructure support covering network, server and cloud environments, maintaining uptime and performance SLAs.
- Collaborated with development and engineering teams to embed security into change and release processes, supporting secure software delivery practices.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led the deployment of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint across an eight-thousand-user estate, significantly improving endpoint visibility and detection coverage across Windows, macOS, iOS and Android platforms.
- Engineered and operationalised a suite of KQL-based SIEM detection rules within Microsoft Sentinel, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD) for high-priority threats including identity attacks and malware campaigns.
- Automated security incident triage and escalation workflows through SOAR playbook development, reducing analyst workload on repetitive alert categories and improving response consistency.
- Delivered end-to-end BAS exercises using Pentera, validating detection coverage against real-world attack scenarios and driving targeted control improvements.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM to secure privileged accounts, eliminating standing administrative access for critical systems and achieving measurable reduction in privilege abuse risk.
- Supported attainment of Cyber Essentials Plus (CE+) certification, coordinating technical evidence collection and remediating control gaps identified during assessment.
- Established a security awareness training programme and phishing simulation schedule that measurably improved staff reporting rates for suspicious emails year-on-year.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid/Remote (London/UK)